

County Administration Workshop: September 8, 2026

1:30 p.m. - Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman,
Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

The Board declared there were no potential conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. Legal

1. Special Service District for DA-Juvenile Justice - Jail

Leah Harper, Assistant Legal Counsel, appeared on behalf of County Counsel Wally Hicks and asked whether the Board wished Legal Counsel to continue preparatory work on a possible special service district for the District Attorney, Juvenile Justice, and Jail. Harper explained that the work would create a potential future funding tool and would not itself impose a tax. The Board discussed that any future tax base or levy would require voter approval and that additional coordination, including with the incorporated cities, would be necessary before a district could be implemented.

The Commissioners discussed whether beginning the preparatory work now would preserve future ballot options or whether the discussion should wait until after the November election. Commissioner Richardson favored completing the preliminary work in advance so a future Board would have the option available. Commissioners Smith and Martin expressed concern with the timing and preferred additional financial information before moving forward.

Finance Director Matt Eide advised that current projections remain relatively stable in the near term but become less certain around the third year. He stated that by spring 2027 Finance should have additional operating data and a better ability to project the funding needs of the Jail and Juvenile Justice programs. The Board discussed revisiting the service-district concept after the election and again after the first of the year when updated financial information is available.

No formal action was taken. The Board tabled the matter until after the November election.

2. Agenda Modifications

Leah Harper, Assistant Legal Counsel, reviewed the rules and best practices governing agenda modifications after public notice has been posted. Harper explained that matters not specifically listed may be raised and discussed when appropriate, but formal action on an unlisted matter should generally be delayed until it can be properly noticed for the public. She noted that some actions have separate statutory notice requirements and should be reviewed with Legal Counsel on a case-by-case basis. The Board also discussed emergency and time-sensitive matters, including grant deadlines, and clarified that once an agenda has been posted it should not be revised after the notice deadline.

No formal action was taken.

b. Finance

1. Board Order 2026-045 Accepting By-Laws

Matt Eide, Finance Director, presented the revised by-laws for the Josephine County Economic Development Grant Advisory Committee. The revisions incorporated the conflict-of-interest language requested by the Board at the prior workshop and included a reference to Oregon government ethics guidance. Eide advised that County Counsel Wally Hicks reviewed the revised language and had no additional changes.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Board Order No. 2026-045, accepting the by-laws for the Josephine County Economic Development Grant Advisory Committee. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

c. Human Resources

1. Position Requisition

- a. Community Justice - Parole and Probation Officer - Add Position
- b. Finance - Accountant II - Add Position
- c. Sheriff - Patrol Deputy - Refill Vacant Position (vacated 9/1/26)

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director, presented the position requisitions. She explained that the Community Justice Parole and Probation Officer and Finance Accountant II positions were added through the recently approved supplemental budget and were being brought forward for implementation. The Sheriff request was to refill a Patrol Deputy position vacated September 1, 2026. The Board had no additional questions.

No separate formal action was taken.

3. Board Business

a. Josephine County Circuit Court Family Treatment Court Application for Anne G. Basker Auditorium Rental November 9, 2026

The Board reviewed the Josephine County Circuit Court Family Treatment Court request to use the Anne G. Basker Auditorium on November 9, 2026. No scheduling or operational concerns were raised.

Approved without objection.

b. Recommendation of Appointment to Addictions Mental Health Public Health Advisory Committee - Grace Curren - Behavioral Health Peer - Substance Use

Scott Hyde, Community Justice Director, recommended the appointment of Grace Curren as the Behavioral Health Peer - Substance Use representative. Hyde stated that Curren works with Addictions Recovery Center in Medford, resides in Josephine County, has attended multiple advisory committee meetings, and has promoted peer-training opportunities in both Jackson and Josephine counties. The committee voted on August 20, 2026, to forward her application to the Board.

Commissioner Martin moved to appoint Grace Curren to the Addictions Mental Health Public Health Advisory Committee as Behavioral Health Peer - Substance Use. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

c. Recommendation of Re-Appointments to the Josephine County Mining Advisory Committee - Don Bellville - At Large and Joel Perkin - At Large

The Board revisited the proposed re-appointments of Don Bellville and Joel Perkin. Commissioner Smith noted that he had not yet completed the additional consultation with a mining attorney regarding potential conflicts of interest that had been discussed at the prior workshop. The Board discussed the relationship between mining expertise and ownership of mining claims, the advisory nature of the committee, and Commissioner Martin's interest in attending a future committee meeting to better understand its work.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the re-appointments of Don Bellville and Joel Perkin to the Josephine County Mining Advisory Committee, both At Large, for four-year terms expiring September 1, 2030. Commissioner Smith seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - No; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 2-1.

d. Oregon Rural Urban Project Application for Anne G. Basker Auditorium Rental Oct. 27, 2026

The Board reviewed the Oregon Rural Urban Project request, submitted for an event associated with Steve Radcliffe, to use the Anne G. Basker Auditorium on October 27, 2026. Staff advised that scheduling is checked before auditorium-use applications are brought to the Board.

Approved without objection.

e. Arguments Supporting the Levy

Commissioner Martin asked whether the Commissioners wished to submit a voter pamphlet argument supporting renewal of the Adult Jail and Juvenile Detention levy. She reviewed prior commissioner-supported arguments, including a 2017 submission, and explained that the \$400 filing cost would be paid personally by the Commissioners rather than with County funds. The filing deadline was later that day. The Board reviewed three draft versions and discussed the role of Commissioners in educating voters, the consequences if the levy failed, the effect of inflation on the existing 93-cent rate, and the importance of maintaining stable Jail and Juvenile Justice services. Commissioner Richardson stated that elected officials should provide the public with the recommendation reached after reviewing the available information, while the Board also emphasized explaining the financial consequences and allowing voters to make the final decision. The Commissioners favored Version 1, centered on keeping existing services working, subject to minor edits.

By consensus without objection, the Board agreed to proceed with a personally funded voter pamphlet argument in support of the levy using Version 1 as the basis for the final submission.

f. Daughters of the American Revolution - Exhibit and Anne G. Basker Auditorium Rental December 8th through December 18th, 2026

Commissioner Martin reported that the Applegate Daughters of the American Revolution had confirmed its nonprofit status and requested use of the Anne G. Basker Auditorium from December 8 through December 18, 2026, for a traveling American Battlefield Trust exhibit. Court use of the auditorium and the Board calendar had been checked for conflicts. The organization would staff the exhibit while open, and event hours would be coordinated with County staff.

Approved without objection.

4. Other: (ORS 192.640(1)...Commissioners may introduce other matters for consideration by the entire board)

Commissioner Richardson reported that he distributed a one-page Organizational Maturity Model overview to Department Heads. He described the model as a framework for moving an organization from reactive operations toward more consistent, proactive service and continuous improvement. Commissioner Martin supported further discussion or training on the concept and emphasized helping departments improve the public's experience while carrying out required County processes.

5. Additional Subject Matters from Commissioners/Announcements:

None heard.

The meeting adjourned at 2:25 p.m.